convert between your application logic and the external service API. Tests internal to the codebase can use a test double to replace the adapter.

For external tests, you saw how to use the VCR gem to simulate interactions with the external server by recording and replaying the actual results of interactions. This allows you to both use real data and not be dependent on the vagaries of network connectivity for your tests to run.

Next up, you'll look at the tools you can use to diagnose failing tests.